

Soft center

Some animals, such as this crab, do not have a skeleton inside them. Instead, they have a hard outer covering, called an exoskeleton.



Inside information

Your bones are all hidden inside your body. So if doctors want to look at them, they have to take special photographs, called X-rays. The X-ray camera can see straight through your skin and show what the bones look like. On this X-ray of a hand, you can see that the bone connected to the little finger is broken.



Your hip joint is where the end of the thigh bone, or femur, fits into a socket in your pelvis. This joint helps you to bend your body almost in half.

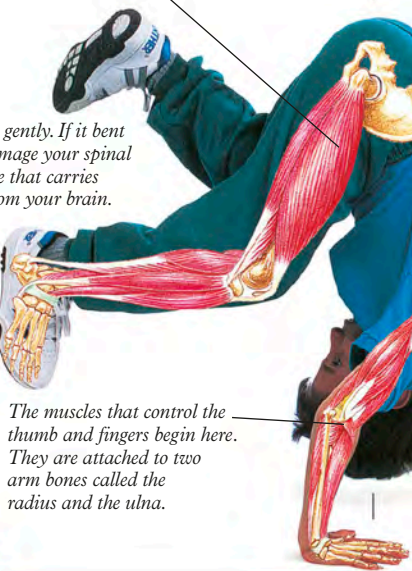
Your basin-shaped pelvis supports the upper half of your body and also protects soft parts, such as your bladder.

Your spine can only curve gently. If it bent any further it would damage your spinal cord—the nerve cable that carries messages to and from your brain.

Skull

Your arm can only bend at the elbow.

Bones give muscles a place to hang on to, but without these muscles, the bones would not be able to move. Muscle power is transferred to the bones along strong bands called tendons.



The muscles that control the thumb and fingers begin here. They are attached to two arm bones called the radius and the ulna.